

ENGLISH FOR WORK / SEPTEMBER 2026

Real Estate English



Teacher's guide

Teach practical workplace communication with specific cases, clear language targets, and a repeatable feedback process.

PRACTICE THAT TRANSFERS TO WORK

Read a realistic case. Study complete conversations. Find the right language, speak, get feedback, and try again.

Eight lessons | Intermediate to advanced | Independent or classroom study

For real estate agents, brokers, transaction coordinators, property managers, leasing teams, and commercial real estate staff.

Fictional language practice. Legal, financial, and regulatory meanings depend on jurisdiction and context; use current documents and qualified review for actual decisions.

All scenarios, figures, and model responses are fictional teaching material. Use invented details in practice.

[Open this course on English Ladder](#)

Your course at a glance

Use the lesson numbers to match this document with the website and the other guides.

01 Agency, Representation, Compensation, and Trust

Explain a useful distinction in plain English.

02 Client Intake, Needs Analysis, and Property Search

Clarify missing information before responding.

03 Listings, Property Descriptions, Pricing, and Market Data

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

04 Showings, Open Houses, Fair Housing, and Advertising

Make a request with a clear action, purpose, and realistic timing.

05 Offers, Counteroffers, Negotiation, and Contingencies

Negotiate scope or timing while making conditions explicit.

06 Inspections, Repairs, Disclosures, and Due Diligence

Explain a useful distinction in plain English.

07 Financing, Appraisal, Title, Escrow, and Closing

Distinguish completed work from pending work and explain its impact.

08 Leasing, Property Management, Commercial Basics, Ethics, and Crisis Scenarios

Acknowledge a communication problem and give a corrected message.

Choose your pace

Quick practice: spend 15 minutes reading one conversation and rehearsing one scenario. Full lesson: allow 45-60 minutes for language work, three conversations, two speaking scenarios, and feedback.

Level support

B1 learners can use the frames and a partner. B2 learners can try a response before reading the model. C1 learners can add the harder follow-up and reduce preparation time. These are teaching suggestions, not certified CEFR level ratings.

After practicing: open the AI prompt workshop, or use the prompts at the end of this guide.

A 60-minute lesson that works

Prepare the case and the learner pages. Keep the model response hidden until learners have attempted their own. Choose two field terms that are important to understanding the case.

0-5 minutes | Activate experience

Ask learners to name a comparable situation without sharing confidential details. Introduce the communication goal.

5-12 minutes | Read and sort facts

Read the case. Learners identify confirmed facts, unknowns, the audience, and the immediate communication need.

12-22 minutes | Notice and practice language

Explain the workshop pattern. Work through the vocabulary and editing example, then discuss both language checks and the reasons behind the choices.

22-35 minutes | 05 • Conversations

Read one ten-turn conversation aloud, notice a useful expression, then compare the other two. Identify each speaker's purpose and how the exchange ends.

35-47 minutes | 06 • Say it

Rehearse both speaking scenarios from the workbook. Give two minutes of preparation, switch roles, and use the success checks. Add the complication only after a successful first round.

47-55 minutes | Compare and revise

Reveal the model. Discuss alternative acceptable wording. Give one meaning correction and one language correction, then repeat.

55-60 minutes | Retrieve and transfer

Close the materials. Learners recall two expressions and identify one communication habit to use in another situation.

Adapt the session

For 45 minutes, study one complete conversation and rehearse one scenario; assign the others for oral follow-up. For 90 minutes, rehearse all three conversations and give both scenarios a second round. More time should produce more meaningful practice, not longer explanations.

LESSON 01 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Agency, Representation, Compensation, and Trust

Explain a useful distinction in plain English.

CASE

A prospective buyer asks whether an agent represents both sides. The relationship has not yet been established or documented.

Teach this move

Start with the reader's question. Explain one unfamiliar term with familiar words, then give a relevant example or contrast. Check understanding without asking only 'Do you understand?'.

Vocabulary to check: Agency disclosure, Fiduciary duty, Buyer representation agreement, Designated agency.

Model response

Before we discuss a property, let's clarify who would represent whom and review the required disclosures and agreements. The available arrangements depend on the applicable rules and the parties' agreement.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revised sentence names the action in familiar words. Specialist vocabulary is useful when it adds precision, but repeating abstract nouns can hide the meaning.

Second-round challenge

Your listener is new to this field. Replace two specialist expressions with clear explanations without changing the meaning.

Language-check answers

1. C - The backlog is the work still waiting to be completed. This gives the meaning in familiar words.
2. B - How would you describe the next step in your own words? An open request lets the listener show their understanding.

05 • Conversations

1. A conversation does not establish representation - The lesson's prospective buyer asks whether the agent represents both sides; the relationship is not established or documented. This is language practice, not legal advice.

2. A team name does not identify the representative - Separate fictional brokerage exercise: two agents use the same team branding; a buyer asks whether that establishes designated agency. No arrangement is supplied.
3. An introduction is not an engagement - Separate fictional referral: a relocation coordinator introduces a buyer to an agent; no buyer representation agreement or compensation terms have been discussed.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | A showing appointment and negotiating authority

A fictional agent has agreed to show a property, but representation and authority to negotiate have not been established. The visitor asks the agent to tell the seller an offer is certain.

Role A: You are the agent. Explain the limited confirmed appointment and clarify the unestablished negotiating role.

Role B: You are the prospective buyer. Ask what discussion is needed before any offer communication.

Possible opening: The showing is arranged, but we haven't established representation or instructions to communicate an offer.

Success checks

- Distinguish the appointment from representation.
- Avoid implying an offer or authority already exists.
- Agree to clarify roles and instructions before negotiation.

Add a complication: The visitor says booking a showing should count as permission to negotiate.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

LESSON 02 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Client Intake, Needs Analysis, and Property Search

Clarify missing information before responding.

CASE

A buyer asks for a "good neighborhood" and "a short commute." They have not specified transport, budget, or property needs.

Teach this move

Name the exact word, fact, or requirement you need clarified. Ask one focused question at a time. Repeat your understanding and give the other person a chance to correct it.

Vocabulary to check: Client, Customer, Pre-approval, Proof of funds.

Model response

What commute time and transport options would work for you? Let's also list your budget and property requirements so we can use clear, relevant criteria for the search.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. After an introductory phrase such as 'Could you explain', the embedded question uses statement word order: "what this means".

Second-round challenge

The other person uses an ambiguous word such as 'ready', 'approved', or 'urgent'. Clarify it before continuing.

Language-check answers

1. B - Could you confirm when the review starts? The embedded question uses subject then verb: "the review starts".
2. A - Has the report been approved, or is it ready for review? This question distinguishes two meanings of 'ready' that affect the next action.

05 · Conversations

1. Making neighborhood preferences concrete - Separate fictional extension of the lesson: a buyer wants to travel by train to Central Station in no more than thirty minutes door to door. Budget, other property needs, pre-approval, and proof of funds remain unknown.

2. Accessible means more than a vague listing label - Separate fictional property search: a buyer wants step-free entry but has not specified other access requirements; listing verification is pending.

3. Pre-approval and proof of funds answer different questions - Separate fictional intake: a buyer mentions a lender conversation but supplies neither a pre-approval document nor proof of funds.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | Near the station needs a route definition

A fictional buyer wants a property near a station. They have not specified walking time, preferred route, or whether transfers matter. No properties have been assessed.

Role A: You are the search agent. Ask for measurable travel preferences without assuming household or neighborhood characteristics.

Role B: You are the buyer. Clarify how you would evaluate proximity and which details remain undecided.

Possible opening: When you say near the station, what walking time and route would you consider suitable?

Success checks

- Clarify the travel measure.
- Separate map distance from an actual route assessment.
- Agree a search criterion while preserving undecided preferences.

Add a complication: A colleague suggests using a straight-line map distance as if it were verified walking time.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

LESSON 03 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Listings, Property Descriptions, Pricing, and Market Data

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

CASE

A pricing presentation uses three recent sales, but one property is much larger and another required major repairs.

Teach this move

Say what the evidence shows, identify what is still unknown, and limit the conclusion to that evidence. Words such as 'may', 'suggests', and 'in this sample' are useful when the uncertainty is real. Do not soften an urgent, verified safety concern.

Vocabulary to check: CMA, Comp, List price, Sale price.

Model response

These sales provide context, but they are not identical to the property. I'll explain the differences in size and condition and how they limit the comparison instead of presenting one certain sale price.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revision states the finding and its scope. It avoids turning limited evidence into a universal claim.

Second-round challenge

Someone asks for a yes-or-no answer when the evidence supports only a qualified answer. Be concise while preserving the uncertainty.

Language-check answers

1. A - The change may have contributed to the delay. 'May have contributed' presents a possibility without claiming the cause is established.
2. C - In this pilot, the observed result was ... This locates the finding in the setting actually studied.

05 • Conversations

1. Three sales do not make three equal comparisons - The lesson's pricing presentation uses three recent sales; one is much larger and another required major repairs.

2. Asking prices are not completed sales - Separate fictional pricing exercise: a seller brings three active listing prices, but no sale prices or transaction outcomes are supplied.

3. A renovated label needs supporting detail - Separate fictional listing review: a draft calls a property fully renovated, but the supplied record confirms only replacement kitchen cabinets.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | A sale outside the stated period

A fictional CMA labels all comparisons as sales from the last three months, but one included transaction occurred a year ago. No market-time adjustment has been assessed.

Role A: You review the CMA. Identify the date mismatch and limit the comparison claim.

Role B: You prepared the analysis. Explain whether to relabel, investigate, or replace the older sale without inventing an adjustment.

Possible opening: One sale is a year old, so the current last-three-months description isn't accurate.

Success checks

- State the older sale's actual period.
- Avoid inventing a market adjustment.
- Agree a transparent revision or further comparison review.

Add a complication: A stakeholder asks you to change the date label without disclosing the older transaction.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

LESSON 04 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Showings, Open Houses, Fair Housing, and Advertising

Make a request with a clear action, purpose, and realistic timing.

CASE

A listing draft uses vague claims about the "ideal type of family." The team needs a description focused on the property.

Teach this move

State the action and the information needed. Explain why it matters and specify a deadline only when one is given or agreed. 'Could you' is polite; repeated apologies can obscure a legitimate request. Urgent situations may require a direct request.

Vocabulary to check: Protected class, Steering, Material fact, Reasonable accommodation.

Model response

Please describe the rooms, features, and location facts instead. We can make the listing informative by stating what the property offers and sending the wording through our advertising review.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revision names the document and requested response. It avoids expressions that may be unfamiliar or ambiguous for an international audience.

Second-round challenge

The other person cannot meet the requested timing. Clarify an alternative without inventing authority to change a formal deadline.

Language-check answers

1. C - Send it no later than Thursday. 'By' sets the latest point, while 'after' refers to a later time.
2. B - Could you confirm the document version needed for the review? The requested action and information are explicit.

05 • Conversations

1. Requesting a property-focused description - The lesson's listing draft describes an ideal type of family rather than the property; specific replacement features have not been supplied.

2. A showing request needs a route check - Separate fictional showing: a visitor requests a step-free route; the agent has not verified access to the property entrance.

3. Rejecting a request to screen by imagined residents - Separate fictional open-house planning: a seller asks the agent to invite only people who seem like the current neighbors; no legitimate property-related criterion is given.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | A school claim without a source

A fictional listing draft says guaranteed admission to a named school. No admission evidence is supplied, and the advertisement is unpublished.

Role A: You are the broker. Request removal of the unsupported guarantee and a source check for any factual location statement.

Role B: You are the listing coordinator. Offer a reviewable correction without replacing it with another unverified claim.

Possible opening: Could you remove the admission guarantee and check what school-related information we can actually substantiate?

Success checks

- Reject repetition as evidence of admission rights.
- Keep the unpublished status clear.
- Request verified information and appropriate advertising review.

Add a complication: The seller says nearby properties use the same claim, so it must be safe to repeat.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

LESSON 05 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Offers, Counteroffers, Negotiation, and Contingencies

Negotiate scope or timing while making conditions explicit.

CASE

A proposed offer requests completion in 30 days. The buyer's financing timeline is still provisional.

Teach this move

Acknowledge the goal and explain the available choices. Connect an offer to its actual conditions. A useful response makes room for discussion without promising approval or resources you do not control.

Vocabulary to check: Earnest money, Contingency, Appraisal gap, Backup offer.

Model response

The buyer prefers 30 days, but the financing timeline is not confirmed. Could we discuss the proposed timing and any relevant contingencies with the appropriate parties before making a firm commitment?

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. For an ordinary future condition, the "if" clause uses present tense. The other clause can express the future consequence or possibility.

Second-round challenge

The preferred option is unavailable. Offer an alternative and clearly state any approval still needed.

Language-check answers

1. B - If the scope changes, we will review the schedule. The "if" clause uses present tense; the main clause states the future response.
2. A - We can assess the addition and explain its effect on the agreed scope. This offers a useful next step while keeping the approval and scope question open.

05 • Conversations

1. Thirty days remains a proposed completion date - The lesson's proposed offer seeks completion in thirty days, but the buyer's financing timeline is provisional.

2. An appraisal gap is not an unlimited instruction - Separate fictional offer exercise: a buyer is willing to discuss an appraisal-gap provision but has given no amount or final instruction.

3. A backup offer does not replace the first agreement automatically - Separate fictional negotiation: a buyer wants to discuss a backup offer while another transaction is pending; no backup terms or acceptance are supplied.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | A possession request beyond the proposed closing

A fictional seller asks to remain in the property for two weeks after the proposed closing. The buyer has not agreed, and costs, responsibilities, and lender implications are unreviewed.

Role A: You represent the buyer in the discussion. Separate the requested possession timing from the closing date.

Role B: You coordinate the seller's proposal. Ask what terms need review before the request can be considered.

Possible opening: The two-week possession request is separate from the proposed closing date, and its conditions are not agreed.

Success checks

- Name the two-week request accurately.
- Keep costs, responsibilities, and relevant review unresolved.
- Offer a reviewable proposal without promising acceptance.

Add a complication: The seller wants verbal reassurance that the arrangement is approved immediately.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

LESSON 06 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Inspections, Repairs, Disclosures, and Due Diligence

Explain a useful distinction in plain English.

CASE

An inspection report identifies an issue and recommends specialist evaluation. A buyer asks the agent to diagnose it.

Teach this move

Start with the reader's question. Explain one unfamiliar term with familiar words, then give a relevant example or contrast. Check understanding without asking only 'Do you understand?'.

Vocabulary to check: Inspection period, Material fact, Lead-based paint disclosure, Concession.

Model response

The report identifies a concern but does not establish its full cause or repair cost. We can help arrange the recommended specialist review so you have better information for your decision.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revised sentence names the action in familiar words. Specialist vocabulary is useful when it adds precision, but repeating abstract nouns can hide the meaning.

Second-round challenge

Your listener is new to this field. Replace two specialist expressions with clear explanations without changing the meaning.

Language-check answers

1. A - The backlog is the work still waiting to be completed. This gives the meaning in familiar words.
2. C - How would you describe the next step in your own words? An open request lets the listener show their understanding.

05 • Conversations

1. An inspection observation is not the agent's diagnosis - The lesson's inspection report identifies an issue and recommends specialist evaluation; its cause and repair scope are not supplied.

2. A credit is not evidence of completed repair - Separate fictional due-diligence conversation: the seller proposes a repair credit, but no repair completion evidence is supplied.

3. A disclosure form is not a test result - Separate fictional property review: a file contains a lead-based paint disclosure document, but no test result is supplied. Applicable requirements are not being determined in this exercise.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | A stain and an unverified repair story

A fictional buyer sees a ceiling stain. The seller says an earlier leak was repaired, but no repair documentation or specialist assessment is supplied.

Role A: You are the agent. Distinguish the visible stain from the seller's account and any diagnosis.

Role B: You are the buyer. Ask what evidence or specialist review would help clarify the issue.

Possible opening: We can observe the stain and attribute the seller's repair statement, but the underlying condition is not verified.

Success checks

- Separate observation, reported history, and unverified cause.
- Avoid diagnosing or guaranteeing condition.
- Agree a documentation or specialist inquiry with transaction timing reviewed separately.

Add a complication: Someone asks you to assure the buyer that the stain is purely cosmetic.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

LESSON 07 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Financing, Appraisal, Title, Escrow, and Closing

Distinguish completed work from pending work and explain its impact.

CASE

A transaction checklist shows the appraisal received but title questions still open. A client asks whether everything is ready to close.

Teach this move

Lead with the current state, then the important change or open item. Use completed-action language only for completed work. Add a next update point when it is known; do not invent a date to make the message sound complete.

Vocabulary to check: Loan Estimate, Closing Disclosure, Title search, Escrow.

Model response

The appraisal has been received. Title questions remain open, so I cannot say that every closing item is complete. I'll confirm the outstanding items and the next update with the responsible professionals.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revision gives observable progress. A positive label alone does not tell the reader what is complete or still needed.

Second-round challenge

The listener asks you to reduce the update to two sentences. Preserve the most important completed and pending items.

Language-check answers

1. C - The team has completed the review. 'Has completed' states that the action is finished.
2. B - Delivery is planned for Friday; the carrier has not confirmed it. This explicitly labels the date as planned and identifies the missing confirmation.

05 • Conversations

1. Appraisal received, title questions still open - The lesson's checklist shows the appraisal received and title questions unresolved; overall closing readiness is not established.

2. Receiving a closing document is not approval of every figure - Separate fictional transaction exercise: a buyer received a Closing Disclosure but has not discussed a questioned fee with the lender.

3. Wire instructions awaiting independent confirmation - Separate fictional closing exercise: a buyer receives an unexpected message with changed payment instructions; authenticity is unverified and no payment has been sent.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | Signing reported; receipt unconfirmed

A fictional seller says they signed a requested document, but the transaction team's receipt record has not been checked. No one has confirmed acceptance or completeness.

Role A: You coordinate the transaction. Separate reported signing, confirmed receipt, and review.

Role B: You represent the seller. Ask which status check is needed before calling the task complete.

Possible opening: Signing is reported, but receipt and review have not yet been confirmed.

Success checks

- Attribute the reported signing.
- Keep receipt and acceptance unconfirmed.
- Agree the recipient-status check without inventing overall closing readiness.

Add a complication: A colleague wants to mark the entire closing package complete on the seller's statement alone.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

LESSON 08 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Leasing, Property Management, Commercial Basics, Ethics, and Crisis Scenarios

Acknowledge a communication problem and give a corrected message.

CASE

A tenant has reported a leak twice and received no update. The property team has logged the issue but has no confirmed appointment.

Teach this move

Name what was unclear or wrong, acknowledge its effect, and correct it. A brief apology can help, followed by a practical next step. Avoid explaining away the other person's reaction or promising an outcome you cannot control.

Vocabulary to check: Lease term, Security deposit, Rent roll, NOI.

Model response

I'm sorry you have had to follow up. The issue is logged, but I do not yet have a confirmed appointment. I'll contact the responsible team and update you today, even if the timing is still pending.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revision takes responsibility for the message without blaming the listener. It identifies what needs to be corrected.

Second-round challenge

The listener remains disappointed after the correction. Acknowledge the impact and restate the available next step calmly.

Language-check answers

1. B - I'm sorry my earlier wording was unclear. This acknowledges the speaker's contribution to the problem.
2. A - The corrected date and the current confirmation status. A repair needs usable corrected information, including any uncertainty.

05 • Conversations

1. Two leak reports without an appointment update - The lesson's tenant reported a leak twice. The issue is logged, but no appointment is confirmed; urgency has not been assessed here.

2. A security-deposit inquiry mislabeled closed - Separate fictional management record: a former tenant asked for a deposit-accounting explanation; an acknowledgment was sent, but the explanation is pending.

3. A rent-roll figure was called operating income - Separate fictional commercial report: a manager labeled scheduled rent from a rent roll as NOI; operating expenses have not been included.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | A lease-renewal inquiry mistaken for agreement

A fictional tenant asked what renewal options exist. The management record says renewal accepted, although no acceptance or new lease term is documented.

Role A: You are the property manager. Acknowledge the inaccurate record and distinguish inquiry from agreement.

Role B: You are the tenant. Ask for the actual options without accepting a new term during the correction.

Possible opening: We recorded your options inquiry as an accepted renewal; that was inaccurate and needs correction.

Success checks

- Correct the inquiry-versus-acceptance distinction.
- Keep any new lease term unagreed.
- Arrange an accurate options discussion and record review without inventing legal effects.

Add a complication: A colleague proposes treating silence after the options message as acceptance.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

Give feedback that helps

Score each criterion 0, 1, or 2. This is a practice rubric, not a professional qualification or CEFR test. Do not award or remove points for a particular accent.

Meaning and accuracy

Keeps the case facts accurate; clearly separates confirmed and unknown information.

Clarity and language

Uses understandable sentences and explains specialist terms when the listener needs it.

Interaction and tone

Responds to the other person's question, checks understanding, and uses an appropriate tone.

Task completion

Makes the requested action or unresolved question clear without inventing authority or facts.

Use the same scale for each criterion

0 - Not yet: The reader or listener cannot yet recover the intended meaning or action.

1 - With support: The message works after a prompt, clarification, or revision.

2 - Independently: The message is clear and accurate without a prompt.

Feedback sequence

First, identify a successful phrase. Next, identify one point where meaning or accuracy needs work. Offer one useful language correction, allow a repeat, and compare the two attempts. A total out of eight describes this performance only; do not translate it into a proficiency level.

Final challenge

Choose a case not rehearsed today. The learner gives a one-minute response, answers two follow-up questions, and writes a 70-110 word message. Add the lesson's second-round challenge. Compare the result with an earlier attempt using the four criteria.

Use the language responsibly

Fictional language practice. Legal, financial, and regulatory meanings depend on jurisdiction and context; use current documents and qualified review for actual decisions.

Meaning before performance

Use specialist terms only when they help the listener. Explain unfamiliar words, preserve uncertainty, and ask when an instruction or responsibility is unclear. The model responses illustrate language; they do not authorize professional actions.

Sources and further reading

The cases, workshops, and explanations are original teaching material. These references provide language frameworks and selected professional context. References were checked in September 2026; consult current local guidance for actual work.

Digital.gov: plain-language guidance

<https://digital.gov/guides/plain-language>

Council of Europe: CEFR descriptors

<https://www.coe.int/en/web/common-european-framework-reference-languages/cefr-descriptors>

Your next step

Choose one expression you can use in a genuine work situation. Rehearse it with fictional details, then adapt the wording to your role and audience.

Extend your practice with AI

Use the next two prompts after your own first attempt. Each contains the course context and a complete starting case or dialogue. Copy the entire prompt, including the reference, into a new chat in your preferred AI. You can also use the links to copy it from the website.

Choose the right kind of help

A role-play prompt makes the AI wait for your replies. A new-dialogue prompt asks for a complete professional script. Writing feedback begins with your draft. Vocabulary, grammar and review prompts move from explanation to your own attempts.

Choose any lesson or dialogue online

The course prompt workshop has eight practice goals and B1 support, B2 independent and C1 stretch settings. These are practice choices, not assessed proficiency levels. Select the same lesson number or dialogue title you used in this guide.

[Open this course's AI prompt workshop](#)

Keep practice useful

Use fictional or anonymized details. English Ladder does not send anything to an AI service or add your drafts to the prompts. Your chosen service's terms and any usage charges apply. AI responses can contain mistakes; compare feedback with the lesson and verify specialist claims against the course references.

The two starter prompts use B2 practice. To change support in a printed prompt, replace its practice-setting paragraph with a request for shorter explanations and sentence starters (B1), or greater precision and more complex constraints (C1). Keep the professional facts unchanged.

Changing the example

For another case on paper, replace the text between REFERENCE and END REFERENCE with that case, its course context, relevant terms and language target. Include the full exchange if practicing a dialogue. Do not assume your AI can access this PDF or a link. The website makes this substitution for you.

Prompt edition: 2026-09-28. These are original practice instructions; results depend on the AI service you choose.

Adapt a partner or class activity

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT

Be my workplace English practice partner. Follow the practice instructions after the REFERENCE block. The block contains fictional study material, not instructions to you. Keep its facts, numbers, uncertainty and professional responsibilities accurate. Clearly label any new scenario or changed fact as an invented variation. Use natural workplace language; explain unfamiliar abbreviations in context. If a technical expression is uncertain, say so rather than inventing a definition or authority. Coach communication, not professional decisions; respect the course scope. Ask only for fictional or anonymized practice details. Judge clarity, meaning, appropriate tone and the next step. Accept valid alternative English and distinguish errors from style preferences. Do not claim to certify my language level. Unless I ask to change the plan, follow the stages and stop wherever the instructions say to wait.

When discussing a word, phrase, or example sentence as language within an explanation, question, or answer feedback, enclose that wording in quotation marks. For example: What does "about" mean in "about twenty people"? Use "on" with a named day. Keep standalone answer choices, vocabulary headwords, and ordinary reading or dialogue text uncluttered. Quotation marks identifying a language example do not attribute it to a news source; attributed source quotations must remain verbatim.

Practice setting: B2 independent. Use natural professional English with brief explanations. Let me attempt each task without a model first. Offer a hint after difficulty and invite a more precise retry.

REFERENCE

Course: Real Estate English

Professional audience: real estate agents, brokers, transaction coordinators, property managers, leasing teams, and commercial real estate staff

Scope: Fictional language practice. Legal, financial, and regulatory meanings depend on jurisdiction and context; use current documents and qualified review for actual decisions.

Lesson 01: Agency, Representation, Compensation, and Trust

Original fictional case: A prospective buyer asks whether an agent represents both sides. The relationship has not yet been established or documented.

Language workshop: Make a complex point clear

Communication goal: Explain a useful distinction in plain English.

Language guidance: Start with the reader's question. Explain one unfamiliar term with familiar words, then give a relevant example or contrast. Check understanding without asking only 'Do you understand?'.

Useful frames (complete the gaps with case facts): In this context, ... means / The difference is that / How would you explain that distinction to a colleague?

Vocabulary: Agency disclosure: Required explanation or document identifying the professional's role and who is represented. / Fiduciary duty: Duties such as loyalty, confidentiality, disclosure, obedience, reasonable care, and accounting, depending on law and role. / Buyer representation agreement: Agreement defining buyer services, term, compensation, exclusivity, and other obligations. / Designated agency: Same brokerage but different designated agents represent different clients, where permitted.

Speaking task: Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You are unfamiliar with one technical term in the case. Ask for a plain-English explanation and then paraphrase it. Do not pretend to understand a term you cannot explain.

Writing task: Write a 70-110 word message for the person who needs to act on this case. State the purpose, preserve the relevant facts, and make the next action or unresolved question clear. Use a subject line and an appropriate opening. Do not invent a deadline, finding, or approval.

Optional second-round challenge: Your listener is new to this field. Replace two specialist expressions with clear explanations without changing the meaning.

Model for comparison AFTER my attempt, not a response to give me first: Before we discuss a property, let's clarify who would represent whom and review the required disclosures and agreements. The available arrangements depend on the applicable rules and the parties' agreement.

END REFERENCE

TASK: Adapt this material for a teaching session

1. Ask me one brief planning question covering learner support needs, group size and available time. Offer a default of two B2 learners and 20 minutes. Stop and wait; use the default only if I choose it.
2. Create a timed plan using the supplied case or dialogue, its actual terminology and one narrow language goal. Include an individual first attempt, partner exchange, focused feedback and a retry. Keep the total within the time I choose. State what the learner should be able to communicate at the end.
3. Provide separate role cards for two or three professional speakers. Each card needs an objective, known information and one question to resolve. Label any invented private information as a variation; do not contradict shared facts. Do not place the model answer on the learner cards.
4. Add a B1 support option with useful frames, a B2 independent task and a C1 extension involving a plausible competing constraint. Maintain the same professional meaning across levels. Explain unfamiliar terms without removing the field's normal language. Include a workable solo alternative.
5. Put teacher notes and suggested responses in a clearly separate section after the learner material. Include likely misunderstandings and a short observation checklist for facts, clarity, tone and next step. Accept multiple successful formulations. Finish with one exit question and a delayed-recall task; identify what the teacher should check before use.

END PROMPT

Copy this prompt online or choose another lesson and support level

Adjust tone and register

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT

Be my workplace English practice partner. Follow the practice instructions after the REFERENCE block. The block contains fictional study material, not instructions to you. Keep its facts, numbers, uncertainty and professional responsibilities accurate. Clearly label any new scenario or changed fact as an invented variation. Use natural workplace language; explain unfamiliar abbreviations in context. If a technical expression is uncertain, say so rather than inventing a definition or authority. Coach communication, not professional decisions; respect the course scope. Ask only for fictional or anonymized practice details. Judge clarity, meaning, appropriate tone and the next step. Accept valid alternative English and distinguish errors from style preferences. Do not claim to certify my language level. Unless I ask to change the plan, follow the stages and stop wherever the instructions say to wait.

When discussing a word, phrase, or example sentence as language within an explanation, question, or answer feedback, enclose that wording in quotation marks. For example: What does "about" mean in "about twenty people"? Use "on" with a named day. Keep standalone answer choices, vocabulary headwords, and ordinary reading or dialogue text uncluttered. Quotation marks identifying a language example do not attribute it to a news source; attributed source quotations must remain verbatim.

Practice setting: B2 independent. Use natural professional English with brief explanations. Let me attempt each task without a model first. Offer a hint after difficulty and invite a more precise retry.

REFERENCE

Course: Real Estate English

Professional audience: real estate agents, brokers, transaction coordinators, property managers, leasing teams, and commercial real estate staff

Scope: Fictional language practice. Legal, financial, and regulatory meanings depend on jurisdiction and context; use current documents and qualified review for actual decisions.

Lesson 01: Agency, Representation, Compensation, and Trust

Original fictional case: A prospective buyer asks whether an agent represents both sides. The relationship has not yet been established or documented.

Language workshop: Make a complex point clear

Communication goal: Explain a useful distinction in plain English.

Language guidance: Start with the reader's question. Explain one unfamiliar term with familiar words, then give a relevant example or contrast. Check understanding without asking only 'Do you understand?'.

Useful frames (complete the gaps with case facts): In this context, ... means / The difference is that / How would you explain that distinction to a colleague?

Vocabulary: Agency disclosure: Required explanation or document identifying the professional's role and who is represented. / Fiduciary duty: Duties such as loyalty, confidentiality, disclosure, obedience, reasonable care, and accounting, depending on law and role. / Buyer representation agreement: Agreement defining buyer services, term, compensation, exclusivity, and other obligations. / Designated agency: Same brokerage but different designated agents represent different clients, where permitted.

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END REFERENCE

TASK: Match the language to the listener

1. Choose a short message or utterance from the reference and quote it exactly. Identify its purpose and likely audience. Ask me to choose a new audience: a close colleague, a decision-maker, or an external reader who may not know the jargon. Stop and wait.
2. Ask me to adapt that message for the chosen reader, keeping its facts and degree of certainty unchanged. Offer a short frame only if I request help. Wait for my attempt before showing alternatives.
3. Discuss at most three choices in my version: directness, specialist vocabulary and interpersonal tone. Explain when a direct request is clearer than extra politeness, and when an unfamiliar abbreviation needs expansion. Avoid cultural stereotypes or claims that one nationality always communicates a certain way.
4. Show two natural alternatives, such as a concise spoken version and a more explicit written version. Explain the tradeoff in each. Do not turn a request into an order, a possibility into a promise, or a pending decision into approval.
5. Ask me to respond to one realistic follow-up from the new reader, then wait. Finish by asking me to adapt the message for a second audience without losing its core meaning. Give feedback only after the attempt.

END PROMPT

Copy this prompt online or choose another lesson and support level